

Creating Maven Ansible Web App:

Step 1: This below Maven command creates a new ansible web application project named **MavenAnsibleWebApp** using the **maven-archetype-webapp** template. It sets the group ID to com.example and runs in non-interactive mode, generating all project files automatically.

```
mvn archetype:generate -DgroupId=com.example -DartifactId=MavenAnsibleWebApp -DarchetypeArtifactId=maven-archetype-webapp -DinteractiveMode=false
```

```
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/mvn archetype:generate -DgroupId=com.example -DartifactId=MavenAnsibleWebApp -DarchetypeArtifactId=maven-archetype-webapp -DinteractiveMode=false
[INFO] Scanning for projects...
[INFO] -----< org.apache.maven:standalone-pom >-----
[INFO] Building Maven Stub Project (No POM) 1
[INFO] ----- [ pom ] -----
[INFO]
[INFO] >>> maven-archetype-plugin:3.4.1:generate (default-cli) > generate-sources @ standalone-pom >>>
[INFO]
[INFO] <<< maven-archetype-plugin:3.4.1:generate (default-cli) < generate-sources @ standalone-pom <<<
[INFO]
[INFO] --- maven-archetype-plugin:3.4.1:generate (default-cli) @ standalone-pom ---
[INFO] Generating project in Interactive mode
Downloading from central: https://repo.maven.apache.org/maven2/archetype-catalog.xml
Downloaded from central: https://repo.maven.apache.org/maven2/archetype-catalog.xml (18 MB at 10.0 MB/s)
[INFO] Using property: groupId = com.example
[INFO] Using property: artifactId = MavenAnsibleWebApp
Define value for property 'version' 1.0-SNAPSHOT:
[INFO] Using property: package = com.example
Confirm properties configuration:
groupId: com.example
artifactId: MavenAnsibleWebApp
version: 1.0-SNAPSHOT
package: com.example
Y:
[INFO] -----
[INFO] Using following parameters for creating project from Old (1.x) Archetype: maven-archetype-webapp:1.0
[INFO] -----
[INFO] Parameter: basedir, Value: /home/shweta/Devops
```

```
[INFO] -----
[INFO] BUILD SUCCESS
[INFO] -----
[INFO] Total time: 14.607 s
[INFO] Finished at: 2026-04-15T03:52:36Z
[INFO] -----
```

Step 2: Configure Maven Ansible Web App Project (pom.xml)

In this step, we move to the project directory using `cd MavenAnsibleWebApp` and open the Maven configuration file using `gedit pom.xml`. Then, we write the required project details, dependencies, WAR packaging settings, and build configuration for creating the web application.

```
<project xmlns="http://maven.apache.org/POM/4.0.0"
xmlns:xsi="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema-instance"
xsi:schemaLocation="http://maven.apache.org/POM/4.0.0 http://maven.apache.org/maven-
v4_0_0.xsd">

<modelVersion>4.0.0</modelVersion>

<groupId>com.example</groupId>

<artifactId>MavenAnsibleWebApp1</artifactId>

<packaging>war</packaging>

<version>1.0-SNAPSHOT</version>

<name>MavenAnsibleWebApp1</name>

<url>http://maven.apache.org</url>

<dependencies>

<dependency>

<groupId>junit</groupId>

<artifactId>junit</artifactId>

<version>3.8.1</version>

<scope>test</scope>

</dependency>

<!-- Servlet API for Java EE -->

<dependency>
```

```
<groupId>javax.servlet</groupId>

<artifactId>javax.servlet-api</artifactId>

<version>4.0.1</version>

<scope>provided</scope>

</dependency>

</dependencies>

<build>

<plugins>

<plugin>

<groupId>org.apache.maven.plugins</groupId>

<artifactId>maven-war-plugin</artifactId>

<version>3.4.0</version>

<!-- Update to latest stable version -->

</plugin>

</plugins>

<finalName>MavenAnsibleWebApp1</finalName>

<!-- create a web page with the name MavenAnsibleWebApp, if we want some other name we
can chage it -->

</build>

</project>
```

Step 3: Create Ansible Configuration Files

In this step, we create a new folder named `ansible` inside the project directory using `mkdir ansible`. Then, we move into the folder using `cd ansible` and create the required Ansible files using `gedit` `hosts.ini` and `gedit` `playbook.yml`. These files are used to define target hosts and deployment tasks for automation.

```
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp$ mkdir ansible
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp$ ls
ansible Jenkinsfile pom.xml src
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp$ cd ansible
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp/ansible$ gedit hosts.ini
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp/ansible$ ls
hosts.ini
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp/ansible$ gedit playbook.yml
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp/ansible$ ls
hosts.ini  playbook.yml
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp/ansible$
```

gedit `playbook.yml`

This code is written inside `playbook.yml` file to automate deployment using Ansible. It targets the web host group, copies the generated WAR file from the Jenkins workspace to the Tomcat webapps folder, and then restarts the Tomcat service so the updated application runs successfully.

- name: Deploy to Tomcat

hosts: web

become: yes

tasks:

- name: Copy WAR file to Tomcat

copy:

src: "/var/snap/jenkins/5013/workspace/MavenAnsibleWebApp1-
/target/MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war"

dest: "/opt/tomcat/webapps/MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war"

remote_src: no

- name: Restart Tomcat

systemd:

name: tomcat

state: restarted

Step 4: Build the Maven Ansible Web Application

In this step, we run the command `mvn clean install` to clean previous files and build the project. Maven compiles the application, packages it as a `.war` file, and stores it in the target folder. After successful completion, the build shows **BUILD SUCCESS** and installs the project files into the local Maven repository.

```
[INFO] No sources to compile
[INFO]
[INFO] --- maven-resources-plugin:2.6:testResources (default-testResources) @ MavenAnsibleWebApp1 ---
[WARNING] Using platform encoding (UTF-8 actually) to copy filtered resources, i.e. build is platform dependent!
[INFO] skip non existing resourceDirectory /home/NK/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/src/test/resources
[INFO]
[INFO] --- maven-compiler-plugin:3.1:testCompile (default-testCompile) @ MavenAnsibleWebApp1 ---
[INFO] No sources to compile
[INFO]
[INFO] --- maven-surefire-plugin:2.12.4:test (default-test) @ MavenAnsibleWebApp1 ---
[INFO] No tests to run.
[INFO]
[INFO] --- maven-war-plugin:3.4.0:war (default-war) @ MavenAnsibleWebApp1 ---
[INFO] Packaging webapp
[INFO] Assembling webapp [MavenAnsibleWebApp1] in [/home/NK/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/target/MavenAnsibleWebApp1]
[INFO] Processing war project
[INFO] Copying webapp resources [/home/NK/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/src/main/webapp]
[INFO] Building war: /home/NK/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/target/MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war
[INFO]
[INFO] --- maven-install-plugin:2.4:install (default-install) @ MavenAnsibleWebApp1 ---
[INFO] Installing /home/NK/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/target/MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war to /home/NK/.m2/repository/com/example/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/1.0-SNAPSHOT/MavenAnsibleWebApp1-1.0-SNAPSHOT.war
[INFO] Installing /home/NK/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/pom.xml to /home/NK/.m2/repository/com/example/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/1.0-SNAPSHOT/MavenAnsibleWebApp1-1.0-SNAPSHOT.pom
[INFO] -----
[INFO] BUILD SUCCESS
[INFO] -----
[INFO] Total time: 1.585 s
[INFO] Finished at: 2026-04-15T04:06:54Z
[INFO] -----
```

Step 5: Verify Project Structure

In this step, we run the tree command to display the complete project structure. It shows important files and folders such as pom.xml, Jenkinsfile, ansible configuration files, source code folders, and the target directory containing the generated MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war file ready for deployment.

```
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp1$ tree
```

```
.
├── ansible
│   ├── hosts.ini
│   └── playbook.yml
├── Jenkinsfile
├── pom.xml
├── src
│   ├── main
│   │   ├── resources
│   │   └── webapp
│   │       ├── index.jsp
│   │       └── WEB-INF
│   │           └── web.xml
├── target
│   ├── classes
│   ├── MavenAnsibleWebApp1
│   │   ├── index.jsp
│   │   ├── META-INF
│   │   └── WEB-INF
│   │       ├── classes
│   │       └── web.xml
│   ├── MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war
│   └── maven-archiver
│       └── pom.properties
```

```
14 directories, 10 files
```

```
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp $ █
```

Setting Up Jenkins Pipeline for MavenAnsibleWebApp

Step 1: To deploy **MavenAnsibleWebApp**, open the terminal, cd into the **MavenAnsibleWebApp** folder, create a **Jenkinsfile** containing the pipeline code, and then commit and push it to GitHub.

```
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp$ gedit Jenkinsfile
shweta@shweta-virtualbox:~/Devops/MavenAnsibleWebApp$ ls
Jenkinsfile  pom.xml  src
```

```
pipeline {
    agent any // Use any available agent

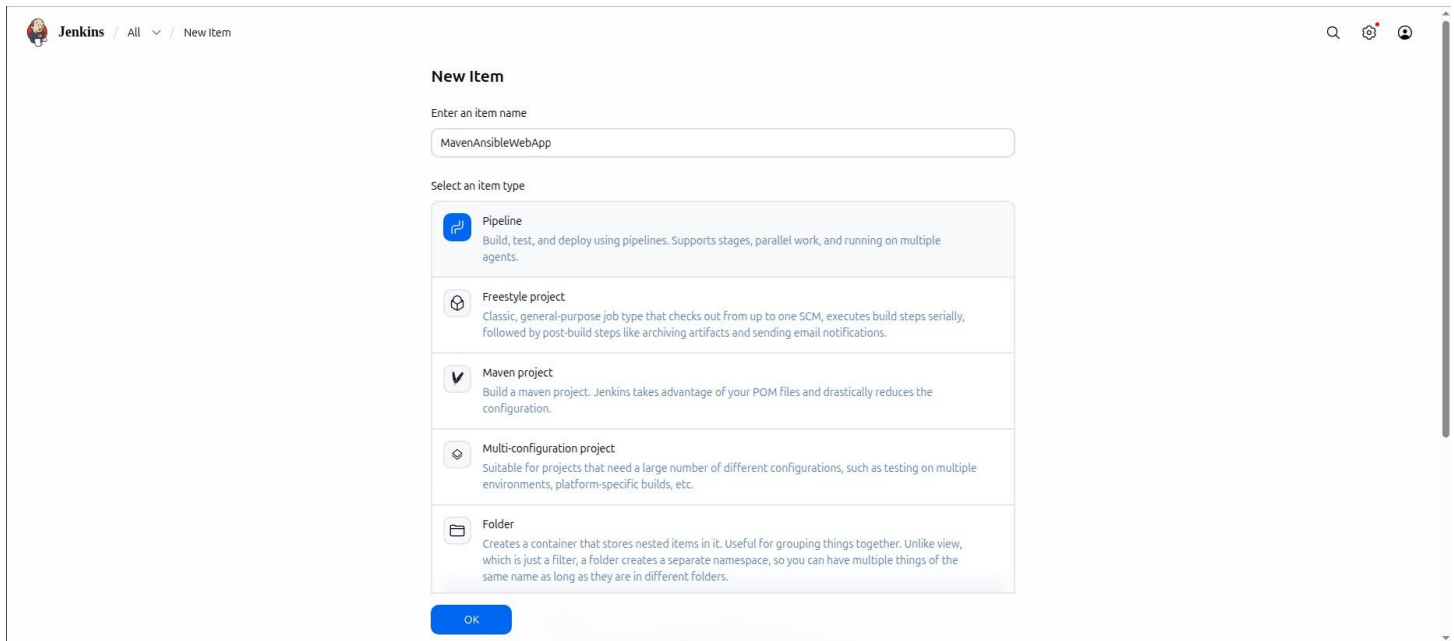
    environment {
        LANG = 'en_US.UTF-8'
        LC_ALL = 'en_US.UTF-8'
    } // this has to be added only if you get an error saying UTF required is 8 but showing in
    ISO00009

    tools {
        maven 'Maven' // Ensure this matches the name configured in Jenkins
    }

    stages {
        stage('Checkout') {
            steps {
                git branch: 'master', url: 'https://github.com/Shweta311204/MavenAnsibleWebApp-
                .git'
            }
        }
    }
}
```

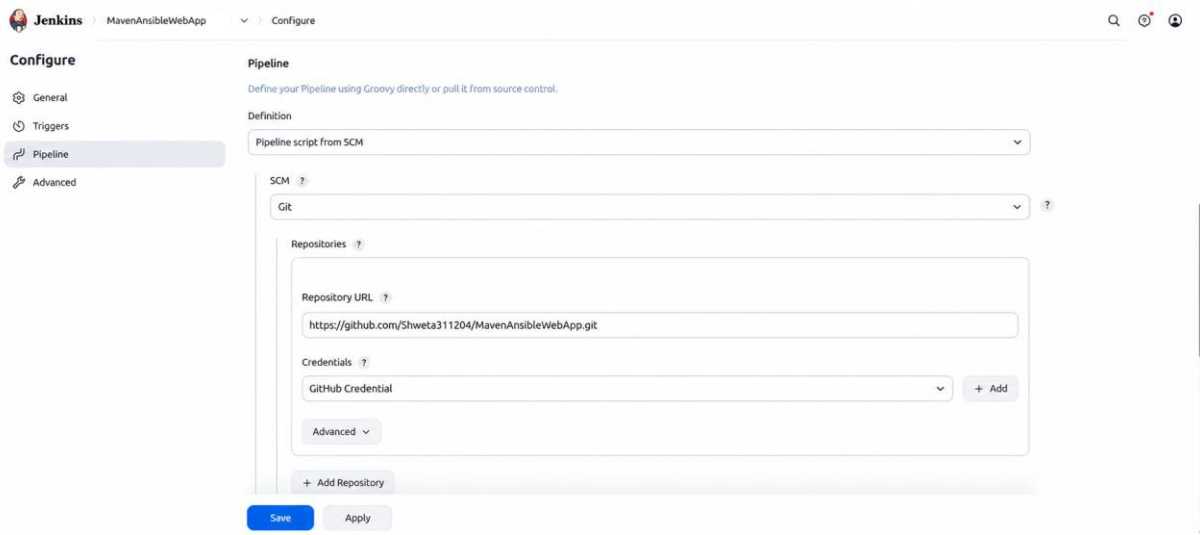
```
stage('Build') {  
    steps {  
        sh 'mvn clean package' // Run Maven build  
    }  
}  
  
stage('Archive') {  
    steps {  
        archiveArtifacts artifacts: 'target/*.war', fingerprint:true  
    }  
}  
  
stage('Deploy') {  
    steps {  
        sh 'mvn clean package'  
        sh 'ansible-playbook ansible/playbook.yml -i ansible/hosts.ini'  
    }  
}  
}
```


Step 2: To deploy **MavenAnsibleWebApp**, you first need to create a Jenkins pipeline job that will use the Jenkinsfile from your project repository. Then, go to the Jenkins home page and click on “**New Item**” to create a job, enter the item name (e.g., *MavenAnsibleWebApp*), and select **Pipeline** as the project type. This option allows you to build, test, and deploy applications using a Jenkinsfile. After selecting the pipeline type, click “**OK**” to proceed to the job configuration page.



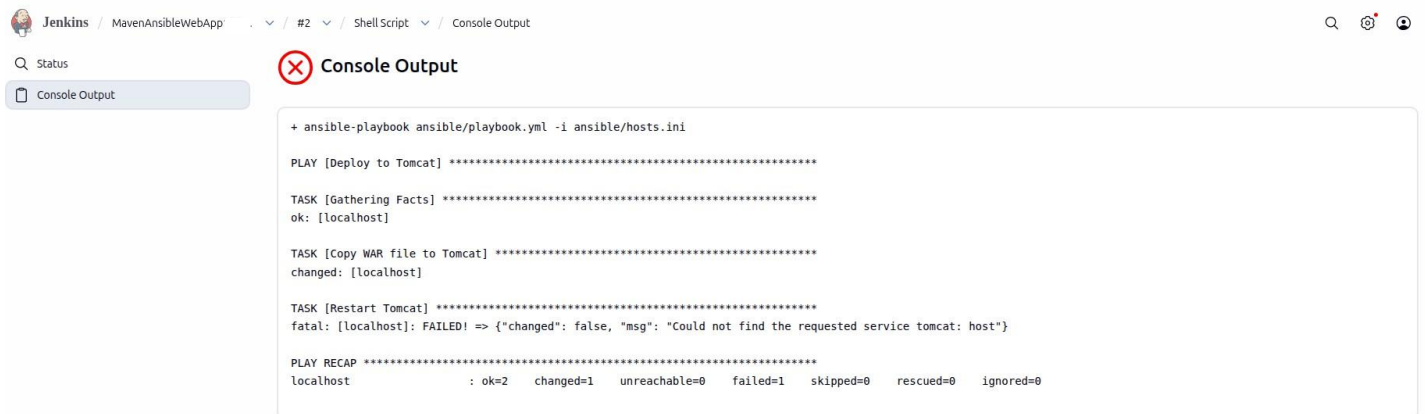
The screenshot shows the Jenkins 'New Item' configuration page. At the top, the breadcrumb navigation reads 'Jenkins / All / New Item'. The main heading is 'New Item'. Below this, there is a text input field labeled 'Enter an item name' with the value 'MavenAnsibleWebApp'. Underneath, a section titled 'Select an item type' lists five options: 'Pipeline' (selected with a blue checkmark), 'Freestyle project', 'Maven project', 'Multi-configuration project', and 'Folder'. Each option has a brief description. At the bottom of the list is an 'OK' button.

Step 3: In **MavenAnsibleWebApp**, go to the **Pipeline** section and under **Definition**, select **Pipeline script from SCM**. Choose **Git** as the SCM, and under **Repository URL**, paste the GitHub URL of **MavenAnsibleWebApp**. In the **Credentials** field, select the previously created credential (e.g., *GitHub Credential*). Finally, in **Script Path**, enter the name of the Jenkinsfile you created in the MavenAnsibleWebApp folder and pushed to GitHub. Then click **Apply** and **Save** to finalize the configuration.



Step 4: Build and Troubleshoot Deployment in Jenkins

After clicking **Apply and Save**, go back to MavenAnsibleWebApp in Jenkins and click **Build Now**. During the initial build, the deployment failed while restarting the Tomcat service because Ansible could not find the service name tomcat.



To resolve this issue, the `playbook.yml` file was updated by replacing the `systemd` restart method with Tomcat manual control commands. Instead of restarting a service named `tomcat`, the script uses `/opt/tomcat/bin/shutdown.sh` to stop the Tomcat server, waits for a few seconds using `sleep 5`, and then starts it again using `/opt/tomcat/bin/startup.sh`. This method works because Tomcat was installed manually and not registered as a system service. After saving the updated playbook, the Jenkins job was executed again, and the application was deployed successfully without any

errors.

The below is the updated playbook.yml file, modified to resolve the Tomcat restart issue by using shutdown and startup commands instead of the systemd service method.

- name: Deploy to Tomcat

hosts: web

become: yes

tasks:

- name: Copy WAR file to Tomcat

copy:

src:

"/var/snap/jenkins/5013/workspace/MavenAnsibleWebApp/target/MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war"

dest: "/opt/tomcat/webapps/MavenAnsibleWebApp1.war"

remote_src: no

- name: Restart Tomcat

shell: |

/opt/tomcat/bin/shutdown.sh || true

sleep 5

/opt/tomcat/bin/startup.sh

Step 5: After making the changes, go back to **MavenAnsibleWebApp1-CICD** in Jenkins and click **Build Now**. The build should complete successfully without any errors.

Jenkins / MavenAnsibleWebApp >

Status

Changes

Build Now

Configure

Delete Pipeline

Full Stage View

Stages

Rename

Pipeline Syntax

Builds >

Filter

Today

#3 8:09 am

#2 8:06 am

#1 7:40 am

MavenAnsibleWebApp

Last Successful Artifacts

MavenAnsibleWebApp.war 1.82 KB view

Stage View

	Declarative: Checkout SCM	Declarative: Tool Install	Checkout	Build	Archive	Deploy
Average stage times: (full run time: ~41s)	2s	271ms	2s	9s	540ms	17s
#3 Apr 15 08:09 No Changes	1s	228ms	2s	8s	495ms	24s
#2 Apr 15 08:06 No Changes	1s	72ms	1s	8s	553ms	9s failed
#1 Apr 15 07:40 No Changes	5s	515ms	4s	11s	658ms	20s failed

Permalinks

- Last build (#3), 1 min 37 sec ago
- Last stable build (#3), 1 min 37 sec ago
- Last successful build (#3), 1 min 37 sec ago
- Last failed build (#2), 4 min 55 sec ago

Add description

Verify MavenAnsibleWebApp Deployment on Tomcat

After completing the Tomcat installation and configuration, we open the terminal and switch to root user mode using `sudo -i`. Then, we move to the Tomcat binary directory using `cd /opt/tomcat/bin` and start the server using `sh startup.sh`. After Tomcat starts successfully, we open the browser and access `http://localhost:9090/MavenAnsibleWebApp1` to verify the deployed application output.



Tomcat Web Application Manager

Message: OK

Manager

List ApplicationsHTML Manager HelpManager HelpServer Status

Applications					
Path	Version	Display Name	Running	Sessions	Commands
/	None specified	Welcome to Tomcat	true	0	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes
/MavenAnsibleWebApp1	None specified	Archetype Created Web Application	true	0	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes
/MymavenWebApp01	None specified	Archetype Created Web Application	true	0	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes
/docs	None specified	Tomcat Documentation	true	0	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes
/examples	None specified	Servlet and JSP Examples	true	0	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes
/host-manager	None specified	Tomcat Host Manager Application	true	0	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes
/manager	None specified	Tomcat Manager Application	true	1	Start Stop Reload Undeploy Expire sessions with idle ≥ 30 minutes

Deploy

← → ↺ ⓘ localhost:9090/MavenAnsibleWebApp1/

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